

Block 3 — Life Span: Adolescence (12–19) · Identity · Cognition · Sexuality

Adolescence — Challenges & Identity 10M

Three Stages

Early (12–14): Contradictory phase. Drastic physical changes. Search for identity. Formal logical operations begin. Question authority.

Middle (14–17): On the road to transformation. Concerned about appearance. Friends pivotal. "Who am I?" Analyse extensively.

Late (17–19): Firm identity. Emotional stability. Think about global concepts (justice, politics). Idealistic views. Intolerance to opposing views.

Challenges

Yearn for independent identity. Challenge parents' rules. Turn to peer groups for belonging.

Identity Crisis & Marcia 10M

Erikson — Identity vs. Role Confusion. Identity crisis = intensive analysis and exploration.

James Marcia (1966, 1976, 1980): Identity = beliefs, abilities, past experiences. Adopted by: sexual orientation, values/ideals, vocational direction.

Four Identity Statuses (Crisis × Commitment)

Status	Crisis?	Commitment?	Description
Foreclosure	No	Yes	Conformed to others' expectations
Diffusion	±	No	Given up on commitments
Moratorium	Yes	Not yet	Actively exploring
Achievement	Yes	Yes	Crisis + commitment made

NOT stages — not sequential or linear. **Lifespan construct:** basis for adult expectations.

Piaget: Formal Operations 10M

4 stages recap: Sensorimotor (0–2) → Pre-operational (2–7) → Concrete operational (7–11) → **Formal operational** (11+).

5 features of adolescent thinking: (1) Possible (hypothetical) (2) Abstract ideas (puns, proverbs, metaphors) (3) **Metacognition** (4) Multidimensional (5) Relative, not absolute.

Only 35% of high school graduates in industrialised countries obtain formal operations.

Adolescent egocentrism (Elkind, 1967): **imaginary audience**, increased self-consciousness.

Sensori-Motor Sub-stages 3M

(1) Reflexes (0–1 mo) · (2) Primary Circular Reactions (1–4 mo) · (3) Secondary Circular Reactions (4–8 mo) · (4) Coordination (8–12 mo) · (5) Tertiary Circular Reactions (12–24 mo) · (6) Early Representational Thought. **Object permanence** at ~7 months.

Information Processing 10M

Model

Sensory register → **Working memory** (7 items) → **Long-term memory**. Retrieval moves LTM→WM.

Hardware = sensory perceptors; Software = mindset/rules/strategies.

Origin: 1950s computers. **Herbert Simon**. Ended dominance of behaviourism.

Four Main Beliefs

(1) Thinking = perceiving, encoding, representing, storing, retrieving. (2) **4 mechanisms:** Encoding · Strategy construction · Automatisation · Generalisation. (3) **Self-modification:** children play active role. (4) **Task analysis:** nature of task constrains performance.

Components (Block 2)

Attention (interest = high getter) · **Perception** (Embedded Figures Test, Witkin 1971) ·

Memory (rehearsal, elaboration, **metamemory**) · Problem-solving.

Sexuality During Adolescence 6M

Puberty: biologically/sexually mature. 1–3 year process. Girls ~1 year earlier.

Hormones: Pituitary gland → FSH → **Testosterone** (males) / **Estrogen** (females).

Males: Testicle enlargement (first) → penis → pubic hair (~13.5 yr) → **nocturnal emissions** (~14 yr) → ejaculation.

Females: Breast development (first) → pubic hair → **menarche** (10–16.5 yr). Ovaries, uterus, fallopian tubes, vagina, hymen.

Concerns: pregnancy, STDs, inappropriate behaviours. Need individualized sex education.

Self-Esteem & Self-Concept 6M

Self-concept: knowledge about self → becomes abstract, complex, **self-schemas**. Three categories: Personal · Social · Self-ideals.

Self-esteem ≠ self-concept: esteem = overall evaluation; concept = domain-specific perceptions.

Self-concept is **consequence, not cause, of high achievement**.

Imaginary audience (Elkind, 1967).

Causes of low self-esteem: hereditary, living conditions, education, physiology, society, fear, disease.

Social Development 10M

Parental influence decreases; peer influence increases. Hero worship. Separation from parents (natural process). Peers define identity. Conformity (rebellion = another form of conformity).

Parents should: listen patiently; not trivialise; understand teen's perspective; offer counselling option.